THE DISPUTED ESTATE

While exact ownership varies across wills, court orders, trusts and corporate entities, the following properties in Udaipur have repeatedly figured in legal disputes involving the royal family:



CITY PALACE COMPLEX

The most prized property, comprising palaces, courtyards, museums and administrative buildings overlooking Lake Pichola. The celebrated Fateh Prakash Palace is inside

SHIV NIWAS PALACE

A heritage palace converted into a luxury hotel, forming a key part of the former royal family's hospitality portfolio

LAKE PALACE (JAG NIWAS)

Now on lease with the Taj Group, the palace has figured in disputes over revenue-sharing and ownership. Operational control rests with hospitality entities

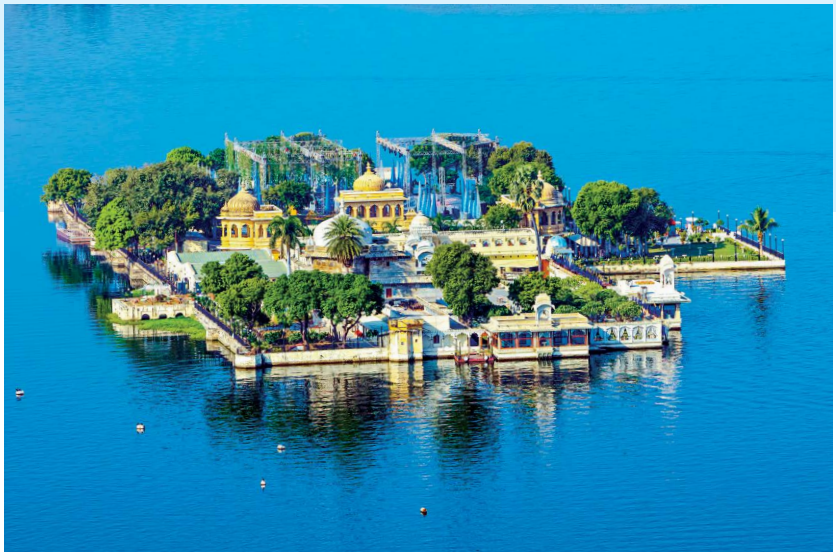


EKLINGJI TEMPLE PROPERTIES

The Eklingji temple complex and associated lands hold deep religious and cultural significance. Traditionally considered sacred trust property, access and control issues have surfaced in family disputes

JAGMANDIR ISLAND PALACE

Located on Lake Pichola, Jagmandir is both a historic monument and a high-value heritage venue



Photographs: SHUTTERSTOCK

a show of strength that could garner public support and taking possession of the properties.

For most of his life, Vishvaraj Singh has lived away from palaces and luxuries with his father, unlike his cousins. Lakshyaraj Singh, though, has no sympathy. "I only ask one thing: Why did my uncle turn against his father and accuse him publicly of wrongdoings? How could he then be expected to be chosen over my father?"

A CITY'S JEWEL

What makes the Mewar dispute uniquely consequential is that the estate includes hotels, museums, urban land parcels and trusts that employ thousands, and define Udaipur's economy. It's a centre of Rajasthan's tourism ecosystem for international dignitaries, destination weddings and global events. Any prolonged uncertainty over ownership or management has direct economic implications.

In Udaipur's bazaars, news of the Delhi notices has spread rapidly. Palace staff tread carefully amid restricted access and shifting allegiances. Political workers invoke lineage and legacy, while tourists remain largely unaware that the palaces they admire are locked in legal limbo.

For the House of Mewar—once celebrated for unity, sacrifice and resilience—the dispute is a sobering reminder that royal lineage offers no immunity from modern law. As Republic Day celebrations faded this year, the symbolism was stark: ancient thrones now yield to contemporary courtrooms, and inheritance is determined not by bloodline or tradition, but by judicial decree. Whether the Delhi High Court's gavel heals the fractures or deepens them remains to be seen. But one thing is clear—Mewar's inheritance, despite decades of litigation, is far from settled. ■